DERMATOLOGY • IEMN • 9190 Haven Ave, 1st Floor • Rancho Cucamonga, CA 91730 • (909) 581-6732
AnhDao V. Le, M.D.

Post-Surgical Wound Care Instructions

1. For the first 24 hrs / 48 hrs , keep area dry from excessive water contacts (bath, pool, jacuzzi).
2. After the first 24 hrs / 48 hrs, you may take a shower ...**then** remove the white pressure dressings.
3. **If wound is clean without oozing**, you may protect and keep the ***"brown steristrips"*** on the **closed wound** clean & dry until they fall off in 5-7 days. Try to protect the steristrips with plastic wrap or waterproof bandage when in the shower. After shower, **please be sure the site is NEVER water-logged and is patted dry** with towel or is dried gently with low setting hair dryer. Keep site covered until you return to clinic for sutures removal in ..... days.
4. **If wound appears oozing or wet or open**, you must do wound care and change new dressings 1-2x/day Use a Q-tip or gauze pads (not cotton balls) and cleanse the site once or twice a day with ***Wound Wash Saline Solution*** or ***hydrogen peroxide*** *if wound appears "dirty" or "fizzling"*. Beware! Using too much hydrogen peroxide (beyond 3 days) can slow wound healing. Many times, cleanse the wound in a shower gently with soap & water is sufficient. Also, please make sure your hands are washed before and after every wound care, as this is critical in preventing infection to wound site.
5. Next, the site must be covered: Use a Q-tip and apply with ***Polysporin*** or ***Neosporin*** or ***Bactroban*** or other non-allergic healing ointment (eg. ***Aquaphor***, plain ***Vaseline***, ***Biafin*** , ***Silvadene*** , ***Bionect***). Next, apply a non-adherent dressing (eg. ***Telfa***), then secure the dressing with paper tape or wound tape. Covering wound helps to prevent infection and help speed healing while minimize scarring and trauma to wound. *Do not allow scabs to form over wound; ointments help keep wound moist & prevent scabbing*. Depending on the extent of the surgery or tightness of your wound, it may take from 7-30 days for your wound to heal or for the sutures to be removed.
6. For the first several days after surgery, local swelling, bruising, or mild drainage (clear yellow or blood-tinged fluid) may occur on and around the wound. If excessive oozing should occur change the dressings 2-3 times a day as necessary. *Watch for any itchy allergic reaction to tape or ointment; Call us!*
7. **Watch for signs of possible infection or urgency**: (a) ***Increased pain after 3 days***, (b) ***increased redness or warmth***, (c) ***milky yellowish discharge***. (d) If ***persistent bleeding*** **occurs, despite applying 20 minutes of constant compression, please call us immediately.**

If you have concerns, please call our office at **909-581-6732** or go to **Urgent Care / ER if after hours**.

ADDITIONAL INSTRUCTIONS :

- ☐ For surgery on head & neck area, try to sleep with your ***head elevated on at least 2 pillows***, and avoid sleeping on the side where surgery was performed. ***Use cold ice packs or frozen peas / corns*** (in Ziploc bag) ***over eyes or over surgical areas*** to reduce swelling and bruising during the first 24 to 48 hrs.
- ☐ ***Refrain from strenuous exercise, straining, heavy lifting, or bending/ stretching of muscle areas*** where surgery was performed, for at least 2-3 weeks or more... depends of wound tightness.
- ☐ ***DO NOT drink alcohol or take aspirin, ibuprofen products (eg., Advil, Aleve, Motrin, Naproxen) during the first 24 to 48 hours***. For any discomfort or pain, you may take 2 of 500mg or 625mg extra-strength Tylenol or any prescribed pain medication given by your doctor.
- ☐ ***After 1 or 2 days, you may resume any medications specifically told to stop prior to surgery***.
- ☐ Remember to ***take prophylactic antibiotics*** as prescribed, esp. if you have diabetes, heart valve disease:
  - ☐ ***Keflex 500 mg*** : *1 gm (2 tablets) on first dose, then 1 tablet 3x/day for total 7-10 days.*
  - ☐ ***Ciprofloxacin/ Omnicef/ Zithromax:***.....

*** Remember to ***return for wound check*** on.....; for ***sutures removal*** in ..... days.

At the R.C. Office